HOW TO SOLVE A NONOGRAM

Read the clues. Fill what must be black. Mark what must be empty.

THE BASIC RULE

Each clue describes a run of consecutive filled cells. If a line has more than one number, the runs appear in that

3 2 1 means 3 filled, gap, 2 filled, gap, 1 filled

USE THREE CELL STATES

Unknown
not decided yet

Filled
definitely black

Empty
definitely white

START WITH CERTAINTY

1. Complete lines

If the clue fills the whole line, every cell is known immediately.

10

2. Squeeze from both ends

For a long run, place it as far left as possible and then as far right as possible. Cells covered both times must be filled.

8

8

certain

3. Mark spaces around a completed block

Once a run is complete, cells immediately beside it must be empty. Marking empties often unlocks the next deduction.

3

KEEP SWITCHING BETWEEN ROWS AND COLUMNS

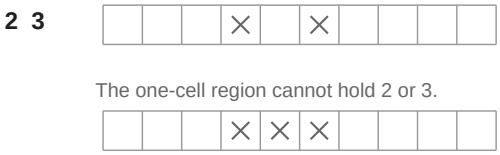
Every confirmed black or empty cell gives new information in the crossing line. Recheck both directions after every discovery.

WHEN THE PUZZLE GETS HARDER

Use stronger deductions only when the simpler ones stop producing new cells.

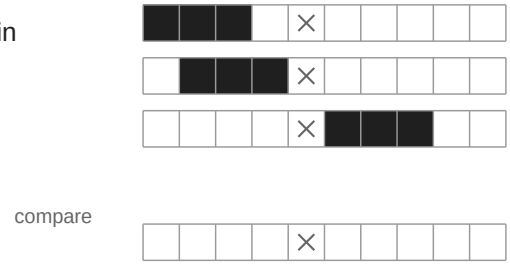
1 USE WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

Known empty cells split a line into smaller regions. If a remaining run cannot fit inside a region, those cells can be ruled out.



2 KEEP WHAT EVERY ARRANGEMENT AGREES ON

Consider the legal ways the clue can still fit the line. A cell that is filled in every surviving arrangement is certain; a cell empty in every arrangement is certainly empty.



3 ASSUME, AND WATCH IT BREAK

If everything stalls, temporarily treat one unsettled cell as filled and follow the consequences through its row and column. If a clue becomes impossible, the assumption was wrong.

This is not guessing: erase the temporary trial and keep only what the contradiction proves.

WHAT THE DIFFICULTY LABELS MEAN

EASY

Squeezing and direct deductions are enough from start to finish.

MEDIUM

Needs deeper line logic and may need contradiction for part of the grid.

HARD

Contradiction reasoning is needed through much of the grid.

ONE SOLUTION. NO GUESSING.

Every puzzle in this book is checked by the solver before publication. There is exactly one solution, and no puzzle that requires guessing is included.